Tailoring Your CRM User Experience

for Greater Productivity

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StratusLIVE

What We'll Cover Today

WHY

Why configuring StratusLIVE for your team drives adoption and eliminates friction

WHO

Who benefits — the user groups and business units that shape your CRM strategy

HOW

How to do it — from simple tweaks to major customizations that expand CRM to new teams

Identifying User Groups & Business Units

The foundation of every great CRM configuration is understanding who uses it and how.

The Foundation of Good CRM Design

Map Your Org Chart to CRM Roles

Development, Finance, Marketing, Programs — each team has unique data needs and workflows that CRM must reflect.

Interview Stakeholders

Discover pain points, daily tasks, and the data each group actually uses vs. what they ignore in the current system.

Prioritize by Impact

Start with the largest or most CRM-dependent teams to prove value fast and build organizational momentum.

Plan for Iteration

User groups evolve — build in regular feedback loops to refine configurations as teams grow and processes change.

Discovery & Design

Invest time here and every configuration decision becomes easier, faster, and more aligned.

A Blueprint Before You Build

Four steps that turn stakeholder conversations into a clear configuration plan

1 Listen

Conduct stakeholder interviews. Observe daily workflows. Understand what data is actually used.

2 Map

Document processes, data flows, and pain points. Translate team needs into CRM requirements and field lists.

3 Prototype

Sketch form layouts and views together with users. Be prepared to iterate.

4 Validate

Test with real users in a sandbox. Confirm the design solves the problem before rolling out to production.

SYNC

StratusLIVE

KEY OUTCOME › A clear configuration blueprint: which fields, views, forms, and apps each team needs — and why.

The Customizations

Three levels — simple, structured, and transformational — each building on the last.

- Simple Customizations
- Model Driven Apps
- New Entities

Simple Customizations

No-code changes that deliver immediate, visible impact — no developer required

New Fields

- Capture data unique to your org
- Track custom donor & program info
- Enables richer reporting & segmentation

Option Set Changes

- Tailor picklists to your terminology
- Remove irrelevant options
- Add values matching real workflows

Views

- Surface the right records, sorted & filtered
- Create team-specific list views
- Save daily searches as one-click views

Forms

- Show only fields each role needs
- Organize tabs & sections logically
- Reduce data entry time & errors

SYNC

StratusLIVE

HOW › All changes configured directly within StratusLIVE's maker tools — no coding required

Model Driven Apps

Applying Simple Customizations at Scale

Bundle your customized views, forms, and fields into a focused, role-specific experience — so each user group sees exactly what they need and nothing more.

What Model Driven Apps Do

- Deliver a tailored navigation experience per team
- Bundle only the relevant entities, views & forms
- Reduce visual clutter for faster user adoption
- Allow multiple apps from one StratusLIVE instance

Example Apps by Team

Development Team

Donor records, gift history, moves management

Finance Team

Transactions, batches, reconciliation views

Programs Team

Beneficiaries, services, outcome tracking

Marketing Team

Campaigns, segments, communication history

Major Customization: New Entities

Expand StratusLIVE to entirely new teams and processes by building custom data tables

What is a New Entity?

A custom data table built inside StratusLIVE to track information not present in the default system, giving entirely new teams a CRM home.

e.g. Case Management, Grant Making, Event Support

When to Build One

When a team's core workflow can't be mapped to existing records. If they're tracking it in spreadsheets or a separate tool, it belongs in your CRM.

e.g. Programs team tracking client services separately from donor data

How It Expands Value

New entities connect to existing CRM data, enabling cross-functional reporting, unified constituent records, and a single source of truth across your org.

e.g. Linking volunteer records to donor records for a 360° constituent view

Key Takeaways

Your CRM Should Fit Your Team.

- Start with your people — map user groups before touching any configuration
- Invest in discovery — interviews and observation prevent costly rework
- Simple customizations deliver fast wins with zero code required
- Model Driven Apps give every team a focused, friction-free CRM experience
- New entities unlock StratusLIVE for teams and processes you haven't tapped yet